

Geriatric Nursing MCQs

Nutrition

1. An older adult reports early satiety and prefers several small meals. Which advice is most appropriate?

- A. One large meal daily
- B. Small, frequent nutrient-dense meals
- C. No snacks
- D. Fasting

Answer: B

2. Which finding should raise concern about dehydration?

- A. Increased urine output
- B. Dry mouth and reduced fluid intake
- C. Weight gain
- D. Increased appetite

Answer: B

3. Why may an older adult become malnourished despite having food available?

- A. Aging always increases appetite
- B. Functional, cognitive, psychological, or social limitations
- C. Protein is unnecessary
- D. All nutrients are poorly absorbed

Answer: B

4. Which assessment is especially important when chewing is difficult?

- A. Hair color
- B. Teeth, gums, tongue, and oral condition
- C. Hand dominance
- D. Shoe size

Answer: B

5. Which meal is most suitable for an older adult with chewing difficulty?

- A. Hard dry foods
- B. Soft easy-to-chew foods
- C. Clear fluids only
- D. No protein foods

Answer: B

6. Reduced taste and smell in later life may contribute to:

- A. Increased appetite
- B. Reduced appetite

C. Increased muscle mass

D. Faster metabolism

Answer: B

7. Which finding may indicate protein-energy malnutrition?

A. Progressive muscle wasting

B. Increased muscle bulk

C. Increased appetite

D. Improved wound healing

Answer: A

8. Which information is most useful when screening nutritional risk?

A. TV preference

B. Recent unintentional weight change and dietary intake

C. Shoe brand

D. Favorite color

Answer: B

9. Which intervention best promotes independence at mealtimes?

A. Feed everyone automatically

B. Offer appropriate choices and encourage self-feeding

C. Remove all choices

D. Ignore preferences

Answer: B

10. Which combination is most relevant to preventing constipation?

A. Fibre, fluid, and activity

B. Hearing and temperature

C. Sleep and height

D. Skin color

Answer: A

Dementia

11. What is the best communication approach for a confused patient with dementia?

- A. Long explanations
- B. Short, simple sentences and one idea at a time
- C. Rapid speech
- D. Several questions at once

Answer: B

12. A patient repeatedly asks when lunch will be served. What should the nurse do?

- A. Say 'I already told you'
- B. Calmly reassure and repeat the information
- C. Ignore the patient
- D. Scold the patient

Answer: B

13. Which intervention may reduce behavioral distress in dementia?

- A. Frequent routine changes
- B. Calm, familiar surroundings
- C. Isolation
- D. More environmental noise

Answer: B

14. Why is person-centered care important in dementia?

- A. It removes the need for assessment
- B. It respects preferences, abilities, and dignity
- C. It cures dementia
- D. It replaces nursing care

Answer: B

15. Which activity is an example of reminiscence therapy?

- A. Memorizing new facts
- B. Discussing meaningful past experiences
- C. Mathematical testing
- D. Restricting conversation

Answer: B

16. Music therapy may help a person with dementia by supporting:

- A. Guaranteed recovery
- B. Engagement, mood, and communication
- C. Medication replacement
- D. Cure of dementia

Answer: B

17. If a patient with dementia struggles with a task, the nurse should:

- A. Do everything immediately
- B. Break it into simple steps and allow time
- C. Rush the patient
- D. Remove all choices

Answer: B

18. A patient becomes more confused in the evening. Which approach is appropriate?

- A. Predictable routine and reduced stimulation
- B. No lighting
- C. Frequent changes
- D. Prolonged daytime bed rest

Answer: A

19. Which finding suggests delirium rather than gradual dementia?

- A. Years of gradual decline
- B. Acute change in attention and mental status
- C. Stable impairment
- D. Long-standing forgetfulness

Answer: B

20. The main nursing goal for a person with dementia is to:

- A. Cure memory loss
- B. Maximize safety, function, dignity, and remaining abilities
- C. Eliminate social interaction
- D. Maintain bed rest

Answer: B

Falls

21. Which assessment is most important when evaluating fall risk?

- A. Gait and balance
- B. Hair texture
- C. Favorite food
- D. Handwriting

Answer: A

22. An older adult becomes dizzy on standing. What is an appropriate nursing action?

- A. Encourage rapid standing
- B. Assess orthostatic changes and contributing medications
- C. Restrict all fluids
- D. Encourage walking alone

Answer: B

23. Which environmental factor increases fall risk?

- A. Good lighting
- B. Loose rugs and clutter
- C. Grab bars
- D. Non-slip footwear

Answer: B

24. Which footwear is safest for an older adult at risk of falls?

- A. Loose slippers
- B. Well-fitting supportive non-slip footwear
- C. High heels
- D. Socks on a smooth floor

Answer: B

25. Why can sedatives increase fall risk?

- A. They improve reactions
- B. They may cause drowsiness, poor balance, and slower reactions
- C. They increase bone density
- D. They improve vision

Answer: B

26. Which exercise approach can help reduce fall risk?

- A. Balance and strength training
- B. Bed rest
- C. Avoiding activity
- D. Only stretching fingers

Answer: A

27. What should the nurse emphasize when an older adult uses a cane?

A-Incorrect use strengthens muscles

B-Correct fitting and safe use

C-Carry it instead of using it

D-Avoid practice

Answer: B

28. Which hospital action promotes safe mobility?

A. Keep items out of reach

B. Keep call bell and essentials accessible

C. Turn off night lighting

D. Encourage unsupervised transfers

Answer: B

Pressure ulcer Prevention

29. Which patient has the greatest pressure-ulcer risk?

- A. Mobile, well-nourished patient
- B. Immobile patient with poor nutrition and moisture exposure
- C. Independent ambulatory patient
- D. Patient who changes position frequently

Answer: B

30. Why does moisture increase pressure ulcer risk?

- A. It strengthens skin
- B. It causes maceration and reduces skin resistance
- C. It improves circulation
- D. It prevents friction

Answer: B

31. Which action reduces shear?

- A. Dragging the patient
- B. Appropriate repositioning and transfer techniques
- C. Excessive head elevation
- D. Pulling by the arms

Answer: B

32. During skin inspection, the nurse should look for:

- A. Redness, discoloration, warmth, and integrity changes
- B. Changes only after pain
- C. Only open wounds
- D. No changes in intact skin

Answer: A

33. How should an immobile high-risk patient be repositioned?

- A. According to an individualized risk-based plan
- B. Never
- C. Only after a wound appears
- D. Without pressure redistribution

Answer: A

34. Which intervention protects the heels?

- A. Constant heel pressure
- B. Appropriate heel offloading
- C. Vigorous massage of reddened skin
- D. Hard surface under heels

Answer: B

35. Which nutritional action supports pressure-injury prevention?

- A. Ignore intake
- B. Monitor intake and address deficiencies
- C. Restrict protein routinely
- D. Avoid fluids

Answer: B

36. Which skin finding needs prompt attention?

- A. New persistent discoloration over a pressure area
- B. Normal intact skin
- C. Warm hands
- D. Normal nails

Answer: A

Urinary Incontinence

37. Leakage occurs after a sudden, intense urge to urinate. Which type is most likely?

- A. Stress
- B. Urge
- C. Overflow
- D. Structural

Answer: B

38. A patient cannot reach the toilet because of severe mobility impairment. This is most consistent with:

- A. Functional incontinence
- B. Stress
- C. Overflow
- D. Mixed

Answer: A

39. Which finding most strongly suggests incomplete bladder emptying?

- A. Overflow leakage
- B. Leakage only with laughter
- C. Urgency only
- D. Night sweating

Answer: A

40. What does a post-void residual measurement determine?

- A. Blood glucose
- B. Urine remaining after voiding
- C. Kidney size
- D. Cognitive status

Answer: B

41. Which intervention is appropriate for functional incontinence?

- A. Make the bathroom harder to reach
- B. Scheduled toileting and improved toilet access
- C. Restrict mobility
- D. Avoid assistive devices

Answer: B

42. What is the purpose of bladder training?

- A. Wait until severe pain
- B. Follow a planned voiding schedule to improve bladder control
- C. Stop all fluids
- D. Maintain bed rest

Answer: B

43. Which finding may indicate skin complications from incontinence?

- A. Moisture-associated redness and irritation
- B. Improved skin integrity
- C. Increased hair growth
- D. Normal dry skin

Answer: A

44. Why should fluid restriction not be routinely used to manage UI?

- A. It can cause dehydration
- B. It always increases bladder capacity
- C. It cures infection
- D. It prevents constipation

Answer: A

General Geriatric Nursing

45. Which principle best reflects person-centered geriatric nursing?

- A. Focus only on disease
- B. Consider function, preferences, safety, independence, and quality of life
- C. Do everything for the patient
- D. Avoid discussing goals

Answer: B

46. Why is medication review especially important in older adults?

- A. They never have adverse effects
- B. Age-related changes and polypharmacy can increase adverse-event risk
- C. All drugs have identical effects
- D. It is only needed in children

Answer: B

47. Which action best supports independence?

- A. Encourage participation in self-care according to ability
- B. Complete all tasks for the patient
- C. Restrict decisions
- D. Limit mobility

Answer: A

48. A comprehensive geriatric assessment should consider:

- A. One disease only
- B. Physical, cognitive, psychological, functional, and social domains
- C. Laboratory results only
- D. Complications only

Answer: B